

## **What is a Domain and Active Directory**

A domain is a collection of resources and users that are administered as a unit with common rules and procedures. In the context of computer networking, a domain refers to a group of computers and devices that are under the control of a central authority, typically a server known as a domain controller. The domain controller manages access to network resources, such as file and print services, and enforces security policies.

Active Directory (AD) is a Microsoft technology that provides a centralized, hierarchical way of organizing and managing resources in a networked environment. It is typically used to manage user accounts, computers, and other resources within a Windows-based domain.

Active Directory provides a unified view of the network resources and enables administrators to manage users, computers, and other resources from a central location. This makes it easier to delegate administrative tasks, enforce security policies, and manage resources more efficiently. Active Directory also provides a hierarchical structure that makes it easier to locate and manage resources, and it integrates with other Microsoft technologies such as Exchange Server, SharePoint, and Windows Server.

In summary, a domain is a logical grouping of resources in a networked environment, while Active Directory is a specific technology that provides a centralized and hierarchical way of managing those resources. Active Directory is commonly used in Windows-based networks to manage user accounts, computers, and other resources, and to enforce security policies and delegate administrative tasks.